

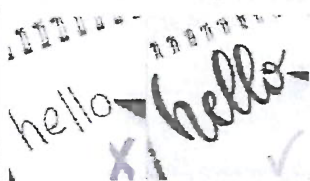
ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a newspaper:

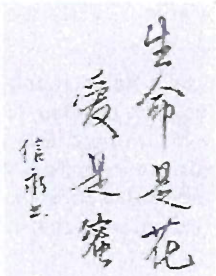
The Lost Art of Handwriting

Technology seems to have affected our handwriting ability. The digital age, with its typing and its texting, has left us unable to jot down the simplest of notes with anything like penmanship.



But does it matter? Some people think so. Many application forms are still completed the old-fashioned way. So are many school assignments. Both of them are judged by the way we form letters on the page. Writing also provides a means to practise hand-eye co-ordination and fine motor skills. Some experts even suggest a link between handwriting and learning ability.

Then there are the more subjective arguments from those who consider writing to be an art form, a historical tradition, a means of expression and even a part of cultural identity. In East Asia, for thousands of years, calligraphy has been regarded as an important art form. Today, in many Chinese and Japanese schools, calligraphy is still taught. In the West, penmanship might not have been quite so recognized as such a major form of art. Yet, calligraphy can still be often seen on Instagram. This shows exactly how relevant and alive beautiful handwriting still is, giving us a means to connect to our cultural roots and express our creativity, as well as some rare moments of silence.



Your school is setting up some new clubs. You are meeting to discuss whether a calligraphy club is a good choice. You may want to talk about:

- whether handwriting is still important today
- how students can improve their handwriting
- activities that can be held by the club
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you like to do your homework with pen and paper?
2. Do you usually take notes with pen and paper?
3. Should teachers give extra marks for good handwriting?
4. Is calligraphy more popular among young people or older people?
5. Should calligraphy be made a school subject?
6. Is it fair to judge a person by their handwriting?
7. Why do you think people collect art like calligraphy?
8. Do you think that handwriting can show someone's personality?